Stage 2: During braces

Bone graft for a cleft in the gum: the three stages

This model shows the same jaw about 2 to 3 years after the bone graft. The child is about 12 to 13 years old. The eye tooth has come down through the new bone. Fixed braces line up the teeth.

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the During braces model

Whole jaw: braces on

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

Whole jaw: braces on

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the During braces model

Braces taken off: the false tooth on the wire

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

Braces taken off: the false tooth on the wire

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the During braces model

From below: the roof of the mouth

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

From below: the roof of the mouth

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the During braces model

Left side: the eye tooth in the row of teeth

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

Left side: the eye tooth in the row of teeth

What has changed

Bone now joins the two parts of the upper jaw where the gap was.[1,2]

The eye tooth came down through the graft into the row of teeth.[3,4]

Most eye teeth come through on their own. Some get stuck. Then a small operation uncovers the tooth, and the braces slowly pull it down.[4,5,6]

Some of the graft shrinks over time. Teeth that move into the graft help keep the bone.[7,8]

The braces

Fixed braces line up the teeth. Almost everyone who has this graft needs them.[1,2]

A false tooth on the brace wire fills the gap where the small tooth never grew. It holds the space until the braces come off.

The pictures show the jaw with and without the braces.

After the operation

In the first weeks, the gum heals over the graft. If the wound opens, you can lose some of the graft.[9,10]

An X-ray at about 3 to 6 months shows how well the new bone has taken.[11,12]

Your hip can be sore for a while after the surgeon takes the bone. In one study, children went back to school about 2 weeks after surgery.[13]

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